

FRENCH REVOLUTION AND NAPOLEON

OLD-REGIME PRESSURE SYSTEM → JUNE-JULY 1789 RUPTURE → REVOLUTIONARY PHASE LADDER → RIGHTS CLAIM AND BOUNDARY → JACOBIN EMERGENCY TRIANGLE → SOCIAL COALITION MATRIX

Read the thick cyan rail from Stage 00 to the final core synthesis. Each card uses a concept-appropriate structure; the grey E card is optional enrichment only and never repairs missing core content.

PRIMARY CORE FLOW SUBORDINATE EXTRA APPROVAL / REVIEW

Approval: FALSE • Pending user review • active generation g1 • explicit approval of this exact generation is required • all prior artifacts unchanged

CORE BEFORE EXTRA • prior artefacts unchanged • exact same master drives poster and tiles

00

STAGE 00 OLD-REGIME PRESSURE SYSTEM

OLD-REGIME PRESSURE SYSTEM LEGAL PRIVILEGE CLERGY AND NOBILITY HOLD EXEMPTIONS FISCAL BREAKDOWN MONARCHY SUMMONS ESTATES-GENERAL BREAD STRESS URBAN AND PEASANT MOBILISATION GRIEVANCE BECOMES A LEGITIMACY CHALLENGE

CORE CLAIM	MECHANISM	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- LEGAL PRIVILEGE → clergy and nobility hold exemptions - FISCAL BREAKDOWN → monarchy summons Estates-General	- BREAD STRESS → urban and peasant mobilisation - ENLIGHTENMENT → grievance becomes a legitimacy challenge	- LEGAL PRIVILEGE → clergy and nobility hold exemptions - FISCAL BREAKDOWN → monarchy summons Estates-General
ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: LEGAL PRIVILEGE → clergy and nobility hold exemptions.		

01

STAGE 01 JUNE-JULY 1789 RUPTURE

JUNE-JULY 1789 RUPTURE 17 JUNE THIRD ESTATE BECOMES NATIONAL ASSEMBLY 20 JUNE TENNIS COURT OATH COMMITS CONSTITUTION-MAKING 14 JULY BASTILLE TURNS CONSTITUTIONAL REVOLT INTO MASS SYMBOL RIGHTS AND LEGAL EQUALITY PROCLAIMED

17 JUNE → Third Estate becomes National Assembly		→	20 JUNE → Tennis Court Oath commits constitution-making		→	14 JULY → Bastille turns constitutional revolt into mass symbol		→	AUGUST → rights and legal equality proclaimed	
CORE CLAIM			MECHANISM			CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT				
• 17 JUNE → Third Estate becomes National Assembly • 20 JUNE → Tennis Court Oath commits constitution-making			• 14 JULY → Bastille turns constitutional revolt into mass symbol • AUGUST → rights and legal equality proclaimed			• 17 JUNE → Third Estate becomes National Assembly • 20 JUNE → Tennis Court Oath commits constitution-making				
ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: 14 JULY → Bastille turns constitutional revolt into mass symbol.										

02

STAGE 02 REVOLUTIONARY PHASE LADDER

REVOLUTIONARY PHASE LADDER NATIONAL ASSEMBLY AND CONSTITUTIONAL MONARCHY REPUBLIC, WAR, JACOBINS AND TERROR DIRECTORY AND CIVILIAN INSTABILITY NAPOLEONIC CONSOLIDATION AND EMPIRE

1789-91 → National Assembly and constitutional monarchy		→	1792-94 → republic, war, Jacobins and Terror		→	1795-99 → Directory and civilian instability		→	1799-1815 → Napoleonic consolidation and empire	
CORE CLAIM			MECHANISM			CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT				
• 1789-91 → National Assembly and constitutional monarchy			• 1795-99 → Directory and civilian instability			• 1789-91 → National Assembly and constitutional monarchy				
• 1792-94 → republic, war, Jacobins and Terror			• 1799-1815 → Napoleonic consolidation and empire			• 1792-94 → republic, war, Jacobins and Terror				
ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: 1795-99 → Directory and civilian instability; 1799-1815 → Napoleonic consolidation and empire.										

03

STAGE 03 RIGHTS CLAIM AND BOUNDARY

RIGHTS CLAIM AND BOUNDARY EQUALITY BEFORE LAW AND CITIZENSHIP NO IMMEDIATE UNIVERSAL SUFFRAGE ACTION WITHOUT EQUAL POLITICAL CITIZENSHIP SLAVERY EXPOSES UNIVERSALISM'S CONTRADICTION

CORE CLAIM	MECHANISM	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
CLAIM → equality before law and citizenship BOUNDARY → no immediate universal suffrage	WOMEN → action without equal political citizenship COLONIES → slavery exposes universalism's contradiction	CLAIM → equality before law and citizenship BOUNDARY → no immediate universal suffrage
CORE CLAIM	MECHANISM	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- CLAIM → equality before law and citizenship - BOUNDARY → no immediate universal suffrage	- WOMEN → action without equal political citizenship - COLONIES → slavery exposes universalism's contradiction	- CLAIM → equality before law and citizenship - BOUNDARY → no immediate universal suffrage
ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: WOMEN → action without equal political citizenship; COLONIES → slavery exposes universalism's contradiction.		

04

STAGE 04 JACOBIN EMERGENCY TRIANGLE

JACOBIN EMERGENCY TRIANGLE EXTERNAL INVASION AND NATIONAL DEFENCE FEAR OF INTERNAL BETRAYAL NARROWING POLITICAL COMPETITION DEMOCRATIC CLAIMS JOINED TO COERCIVE VIOLENCE

WAR → external invasion and national defence		
COUNTER-REVOLUTION → fear of internal betrayal	FACTION → narrowing political competition	TERROR → democratic claims joined to coercive violence
CORE CLAIM	MECHANISM	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
• WAR → external invasion and national defence • COUNTER-REVOLUTION → fear of internal betrayal	• FACTION → narrowing political competition • TERROR → democratic claims joined to coercive violence	• WAR → external invasion and national defence • COUNTER-REVOLUTION → fear of internal betrayal
ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: TERROR → democratic claims joined to coercive violence.		

05

STAGE 05 SOCIAL COALITION MATRIX

SOCIAL COALITION MATRIX OFFICE, PROPERTY AND LEGAL EQUALITY END DUES, RENTS AND FEUDAL BURDENS URBAN CROWD BREAD, VOICE AND SOCIAL EQUALITY ORDER, MERIT AND LATER NAPOLEONIC AUTHORITY

CORE CLAIM	MECHANISM	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
BOURGEOISIE → office, property and legal equality PEASANTRY → end dues, rents and feudal burdens	URBAN CROWD → bread, voice and social equality ARMY → order, merit and later Napoleonic authority	BOURGEOISIE → office, property and legal equality PEASANTRY → end dues, rents and feudal burdens
CORE CLAIM	MECHANISM	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- BOURGEOISIE → office, property and legal equality - PEASANTRY → end dues, rents and feudal burdens	- URBAN CROWD → bread, voice and social equality - ARMY → order, merit and later Napoleonic authority	- BOURGEOISIE → office, property and legal equality - PEASANTRY → end dues, rents and feudal burdens
ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: ARMY → order, merit and later Napoleonic authority.		

06

STAGE 06 NAPOLEON'S INHERITANCE LEDGER

NAPOLEON'S INHERITANCE LEDGER ANTI-FEUDAL REFORM AND LEGAL RATIONALISATION CAREERS OPEN TO TALENT AND CODIFIED LAW REPUBLIC, FREE POLITICS AND POPULAR SOVEREIGNTY REFORM THROUGH CONQUEST AND OCCUPATION

CORE CLAIM	MECHANISM	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
PRESERVED → anti-feudal reform and legal rationalisation EXPANDED → careers open to talent and codified law	CURTAILED → republic, free politics and popular sovereignty EXPORTED → reform through conquest and occupation	PRESERVED → anti-feudal reform and legal rationalisation EXPANDED → careers open to talent and codified law
CORE CLAIM	MECHANISM	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- PRESERVED → anti-feudal reform and legal rationalisation - EXPANDED → careers open to talent and codified law	- CURTAILED → republic, free politics and popular sovereignty - EXPORTED → reform through conquest and occupation	- PRESERVED → anti-feudal reform and legal rationalisation - EXPANDED → careers open to talent and codified law
ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: CURTAILED → republic, free politics and popular sovereignty.		

07

STAGE 07 ABOLITION AND REVERSAL

ABOLITION AND REVERSAL REVOLUTIONARY PHASE SLAVERY ABOLISHED IN FRENCH COLONIES ABOLITION REVERSED RIGHTS PROBLEM COLONY TESTS UNIVERSAL CITIZENSHIP FINAL FRENCH ABOLITION

REVOLUTIONARY PHASE → slavery abolished in French colonies		NAPOLEON → abolition reversed	RIGHTS PROBLEM → colony tests universal citizenship	1848 → final French abolition
CORE CLAIM		MECHANISM		CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
* REVOLUTIONARY PHASE → slavery abolished in French colonies * NAPOLEON → abolition reversed		* RIGHTS PROBLEM → colony tests universal citizenship * 1848 → final French abolition		* REVOLUTIONARY PHASE → slavery abolished in French colonies * NAPOLEON → abolition reversed
ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: REVOLUTIONARY PHASE → slavery abolished in French colonies.				

08

STAGE 08 NATION AND CITIZENSHIP

NATION AND CITIZENSHIP SUBJECT OF KING INHERITED OBEDIENCE BEARER OF PUBLIC RIGHTS AND DUTIES PEOPLE BECOMES SOURCE OF SOVEREIGNTY NATIONALISM AND CONSTITUTIONALISM GAIN A NEW GRAMMAR

SUBJECT OF KING → inherited obedience		→	CITIZEN → bearer of public rights and duties		→	NATION → people becomes source of sovereignty		→	LEGACY → nationalism and constitutionalism gain a new grammar	
CORE CLAIM			MECHANISM			CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT				
* SUBJECT OF KING → inherited obedience			* NATION → people becomes source of sovereignty			* SUBJECT OF KING → inherited obedience				
* CITIZEN → bearer of public rights and duties			* LEGACY → nationalism and constitutionalism gain a new grammar			* CITIZEN → bearer of public rights and duties				
ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: LEGACY → nationalism and constitutionalism gain a new grammar.										

09

STAGE 09 WHY MODERATE SETTLEMENT FAILED

WHY MODERATE SETTLEMENT FAILED 1791 CONSTITUTION LEGAL OLD REGIME BROKEN FISCAL, RELIGIOUS AND WAR CRISES REMAIN POPULAR CLASSES DEMAND DEEPER CHANGE MONARCHY FALLS AND REPUBLIC BEGINS

1791 CONSTITUTION → legal old regime broken	UNRESOLVED → fiscal, religious and war crises remain	MOBILISATION → popular classes demand deeper change	OUTCOME → monarchy falls and republic begins
CORE CLAIM 1791 CONSTITUTION → legal old regime broken - UNRESOLVED → fiscal, religious and war crises remain	MECHANISM - MOBILISATION → popular classes demand deeper change - OUTCOME → monarchy falls and republic begins	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT 1791 CONSTITUTION → legal old regime broken - UNRESOLVED → fiscal, religious and war crises remain	
ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: UNRESOLVED → fiscal, religious and war crises remain.			

10

STAGE 10 NON-LINEAR REVOLUTIONARY LEGACY

NON-LINEAR REVOLUTIONARY LEGACY RIGHTS AND LEGAL RUPTURE TERROR TESTS LIBERTY EMPIRE KEEPS SOCIAL GAINS, ENDS REPUBLIC 1815 ONWARD RESTORATION FACES RENEWED NATIONALISM

1789 → rights and legal rupture		→	1793-94 → Terror tests liberty		→	1799-1815 → empire keeps social gains, ends republic		→	1815 ONWARD → restoration faces renewed nationalism	
CORE CLAIM			MECHANISM			CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT				
* 1789 → rights and legal rupture * 1793-94 → Terror tests liberty			* 1799-1815 → empire keeps social gains, ends republic * 1815 ONWARD → restoration faces renewed nationalism			* 1789 → rights and legal rupture * 1793-94 → Terror tests liberty				
ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: 1799-1815 → empire keeps social gains, ends republic.										

11

STAGE 11 FRENCH REVOLUTION ANSWER SPINE

FRENCH REVOLUTION ANSWER SPINE PRIVILEGE + FISCAL CRISIS + BREAD + IDEAS 1789 RUPTURE SOCIAL CONSOLIDATION + POLITICAL REVERSAL LEGITIMACY CHANGED MORE FULLY THAN SOCIAL EQUALITY

CAUSE → privilege + fiscal crisis + bread + ideas		COURSE → 1789 rupture → republic → Terror → Directory	NAPOLEON → social consolidation + political reversal	VERDICT → legitimacy changed more fully than social equality
CORE CLAIM		MECHANISM		CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
• CAUSE → privilege + fiscal crisis + bread + ideas • COURSE → 1789 rupture → republic → Terror → Directory		• NAPOLEON → social consolidation + political reversal • VERDICT → legitimacy changed more fully than social equality		• CAUSE → privilege + fiscal crisis + bread + ideas • COURSE → 1789 rupture → republic → Terror → Directory
ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: VERDICT → legitimacy changed more fully than social equality.				

E

EXTRA SUBORDINATE ENRICHMENT — ONLY AFTER THE COMPLETE CORE

OPTIONAL ADVANCED ENRICHMENT OLD NCERT IS ESPECIALLY USEFUL BECAUSE IT SHOWS THAT ON ELITE THINKERS BUT ALSO ON WORKERS, ARTISANS, PEASANTS THIS IS IMPORTANT IN MAINS ANSWERS DO NOT WRITE THE EVENT AS IF PAMPHLETS ALONE
OLD NCERT STATES THAT THE JACOBINS BELIEVED IN DIRECT IT ALSO NOTES THAT IN 14 MONTHS AROUND 17,000 UNDER THE JACOBIN CONSTITUTION, OLD NCERT HIGHLIGHTS UNIVERSAL MALE

OPTIONAL SOURCE DEPTH	ADVANCED DEBATE	LEGACY / NUANCE
- Old NCERT is especially useful because it shows that the Revolution rested not only on elite thinkers but also on workers, artisans, peasants and the Paris crowd. - CAUTION: This is important in mains answers: do not write the event as if pamphlets alone toppled the old regime. - Old NCERT states that the Jacobins believed in direct democracy and, fearing danger to the Revolution, adopted harsh measures.	- It also notes that in 14 months around 17,000 people were tried and executed. - Under the Jacobin constitution, old NCERT highlights universal male political rights, the right of insurrection, and the principle that government must provide work or livelihood. - CAUTION: Therefore the Terror cannot be dismissed as mere madness	- nor can it be romanticised. - It joined mass democracy, war emergency and coercive violence in one unstable package. - CAUTION: Best formulation: Napoleon stabilised the social revolution while reversing much of its political republicanism. - Old NCERT says the French Revolution inspired movements in almost every country of Europe and in South and Central America.
OPTIONAL STATUS — This optional depth is unnecessary for a competent core answer; use it only for added nuance after the complete core has been written.		